

[00:00:00.430] - Chris Johnstone

Going forth... Madeleine, do you want to say anything about going forth?

[00:00:05.470] - Madeleine Young

Yeah.

[00:00:07.930] - Madeleine Young

It feels for me like an opening out into what's coming next. But also like a structuring - a drawing together of all the tools and things. It's like if I was setting off on a particular adventure, I'd think, what am I going to need? I'm like, oh, there might be moments when it might get really cold - I'm going to pack my hot water bottle. So going forth feels a bit like that. It's like, okay, which direction do I want to set out on and what's going to best support me?

[00:00:43.630] - Madeleine Young

And how can I surround myself with that?

[00:00:46.510] - Chris Johnstone

I love that. And I'm also thinking that we're following on from the looking from your hopes that we did with Rob last week. And there's something about what I deeply hope will happen. But also the part that I might play in that, and going forth is an opportunity just to get clearer, to get clearer about what that is. And what I'm aware of is that sometimes there's foggy and sometimes there's clarity and whatever there is, whether foggy or clarity. It's like, how do you work with wherever you are?

[00:01:26.390] - Chris Johnstone

So, if you've got foggy, how do you, like work with the foggy in a way that helps you find a way through it. But if you've got clarity, how do you support your clarity with clear planning?

[00:01:45.230] - Madeleine Young

I really like that, Chris, particularly because I feel a certain amount of foggy today. So that makes me feel that it's okay to be feeling that at this stage.

[00:01:57.050] - Chris Johnstone

And there's something also, I suppose we were thinking about systems, systems being different levels. And I'm finding this idea of systems - and larger things happen through smaller things - very helpful when it comes to going forth, because my deep hope is that we wake up, we really get it. We have this shift, this turning over of a new leaf in terms of acting for the great turning, acting for the flourishing of life. And that seems like such a huge thing. But it's kind of like saying, well, if that's a big picture, what are some of the different elements in the picture and then also, within those elements, what are some of the parts of that?

[00:02:42.170] - Chris Johnstone

And then, within some of the parts of that, where might I kind of fit in? And what I like is this idea of, like, pieces of a jigsaw... Where's a good fit? I can fit in here. I can fit in here. I can fit in there. And there's lots of different ways that we can fit in. And I love the idea of, well, the big happened through the small. And if I was to do something small today that the big happened through, what would that be?

[00:03:14.450] - Chris Johnstone

And so then comes the questions of, well, which big, which big things do we want to do? And so we're going to be doing a process together in terms of looking at storyboarding as a tool. But before we do that, we were going to be looking at just mapping out some of the different elements of this larger story of the Great Turning. And I wonder if you'd like to say anything about the three dimensions as a way of thinking or looking at the Great turning.

[00:03:49.610] - Madeleine Young

Yeah.

[00:03:50.090] - Madeleine Young

No, I'd like to, because the three dimensions is one of the aspects of the Work that Reconnects that when I learned about it... Actually, I think I probably learnt about it reading Active Hope. That was the first that I learned about it.

[00:04:06.290] - Madeleine Young

And

[00:04:08.810] - Madeleine Young

it was really powerful for me because it was like it gave a much wider definition of activism than what I had been functioning on for all of my life. So for all of my life, I had kind of thought, oh, yeah, if I am going to make a difference, I have to do it this one particular way, and I would try and it would maybe not work that well for me. Sometimes it would. And sometimes it wouldn't. This sense that there are different dimensions to the Great Turning, and each of the dimensions are equally vital and they're equal to each other.

[00:04:49.790] - Madeleine Young

So it's not like a hierarchy. It's not like one is any more important than any of the others.

[00:04:53.990] - Madeleine Young

And

[00:04:55.970] - Madeleine Young

they all need each other. They're all interdependent, and none of them will work that well without the others. Would you like me to, actually...

[00:05:04.910] - Chris Johnstone

Yeah. Do you want to say a bit more about how you see them?

[00:05:08.810] - Madeleine Young

Yeah. So I'll start with the one that was probably, for me, it was how I thought of activism before, which is "holding actions", so that's anything that will hold back the Great Unravelling - that will help to limit the damage that's being done, on all different levels, whether that's ecologically or within the way we relate to each other or within our societies, whatever aspect it is. It's like trying to just hold back the damage. And so that can be going on marches, signing petitions, people doing whistleblowing all the ways that it's like people standing in the way of anything that's doing harm.

[00:06:09.170] - Madeleine Young

It's really necessary work. But it also really can be quite exhausting.

[00:06:14.150] - Madeleine Young

Because

[00:06:18.330] - Madeleine Young

there are times when it can be successful. But then there's this sense of, like the Business as Usual, keeps kind of grinding on, and we could be holding holding all the time and just gradually wearing away ourselves. So I really like the sense that actually I can flow between different dimensions at different moments in my life. So, yes, there's this holding actions dimension. But then there's another dimension, which is like creating structures and systems that will work as in they will be with the greater whole, the system of our universe that works.

[00:07:03.450] - Madeleine Young

They'll be in keeping with that. And so that's really important because we could hold back everything - we could be successful at holding back everything - but if we haven't created an alternative, then what is there for us to turn to? And so that's everything where people are reimagining it and exploring and experimenting with alternatives. That's part of this dimension. And then the third dimension is the shift in consciousness. So, like, the shift that happens inside of each of us. And that is absolutely vital

because we could have stopped everything.

[00:08:05.250] - Madeleine Young

We could have created this alternative. And if we haven't done that work on ourselves, like dismantling those weapons, like we said, if we haven't shifted those patterns of oppression that we've got inside ourselves, then we will just create the same mess over again. This is everything in terms of decolonisation, in terms of regenerative cultures - which is where people are learning how to relate to each other and how to carry out all that we need to do in a way that is sustainable, like, for each individual and for the whole.

[00:08:46.350] - Madeleine Young

And so, yeah, it was so amazing for me to realise, actually, those moments when I need to take time out from waving a placard or whatever. And I don't even feel up to sorting out... But I'm working on myself. That is a fundamental part of the Great Turning as well. And so, yeah, I love this way that it's all valued - all of those. And in fact, we'll need to look for the credit for this because this was somebody that I read that introduced me to this.

[00:09:24.690] - Madeleine Young

That, actually, as the Great Turning proceeds, those three dimensions become more and more integrated. So actually, for the shift to happen, we need to be bringing all of those together so that we're actually taking our best selves into these systems that we've created. And that is holding everything. So, yeah, it's all coming together!

[00:09:54.090] - Chris Johnstone

Really beautifully put, really helpfully put.

[00:09:56.670] - Chris Johnstone

And I love this idea of, well, there's things that you hope for. And there are some things that you really hope for, it's like, it's a deeper hope. And if we think of the deeper shared hopes, and one of the most basic is that facing the mess we're in, we'll find our best way through - that we'll find a way through this evolutionary tight spot. And it's not guaranteed that we will. We're facing this pivotal uncertainty of will we make it... Will we make it through? And I certainly hope we will.

[00:10:39.450] - Chris Johnstone

And so it's like, well, okay, if I hope we will, then how can I support my hopes? And I really love this idea of hopes can be activated within us. And just as the big can happen through the small or the circle can happen through the squares, our hopes can happen through us. And what you're describing with these three dimensions are some of the different ways, some of the different ways we can support our hopes or our hopes can happen through us. If our deep hopes for a collective future is activated within us, how would that happen through us?

[00:11:21.390] - Chris Johnstone

How can we support that? And I love this idea of, well, we can support our hopes by giving something to them. And this idea of our gift of active hope, our gift of active hope. It could be the gift of showing up. The gift of our attention, the gift of caring. But also what going forth does is it really invites us to be a bit more specific about what are some of the specific things that I would love to offer to this process of creating the future or moving towards the future or making more likely the future that I hope for, that we hope for.

[00:12:02.850] - Chris Johnstone

And so in each of those areas, in the holding actions, I think of it as like being a defender, being a defender of what we want to preserve. And I love this idea of activism as being active for purposes that are bigger than you are, and you can be active for your family, but also, whatever you look at, if you say what's it part of? What's even the bigger story? If I can be active in support of that. So the communities that I'm part of, the species that I'm part of, but also this insight of interconnectedness is that it's no good just looking after human survival

[00:12:51.510] - Chris Johnstone

if the world is destroyed around us because we arise out of our world. We're dependent on our world anyway. So going forth, holding actions, being a defender. And then I love this idea of what are the sprouts? What do we want to cultivate and help grow and both life sustaining systems, but also life sustaining practices? What does that look like? How do I engage in that? And, as you say, sort of sustainable approaches to agriculture, but also education and health care and the whole ways that we organise ourselves as societies, as communities.

[00:13:32.550] - Chris Johnstone

And then this consciousness shift. The thing that really lands with me is this incredible moment which we are part of historically, of being amongst the first generations of humans to see pictures of the Earth as a whole. And I think that's an incredible thing. And it leads to the potential shift from I'm just from this bit of land or that bit of land to I am a planet person. I am from this planet Earth, and I don't think we've ever had that historically before. I think that many ancient traditions from around our world have really had a deep sense of we are part of our world, and it's so important that we learn from those different ancient cultures, Indigenous cultures.

[00:14:28.590] - Chris Johnstone

And also there's something about this historical moment of seeing ourselves as part of this shared planet. I don't know. How does any of this sound with you? I'm just kind of revisiting what you've said and then just adding some themes and threads that came to me.

[00:14:50.550] - Madeleine Young

Yes, I love that sense of the sprouts as well. That did something for me. I was like, yes. So in a way, the going forth seems to me like, how can we water these different aspects in ourselves? And I think for me also, there's a sense that these dimensions overlap and it's possible to do things in more than one dimension at a time. In fact, that's like, great. But also I get a sense of an ebb and flow in my life, and that actually it's quite good to be quite tender and really supportive of myself when I'm shifting from more one sphere to another.

[00:15:47.770] - Madeleine Young

And actually, that's the time when the active hope practices are most useful for me, because I was saying, actually, I feel a little bit not that clear right now. And that's because I am actually in a moment of slightly feeling a calling towards a new direction. So that's a time when it's really handy for me to do more of the practices and actually kind of make the space to actually hear what wants to happen through me and find the ways to support it. But I think, in the past, it would have been a time when I would have really got at myself like, oh, you're not doing anything feeling all fuzzy what's going on.

[00:16:28.810] - Madeleine Young

So it's actually like recognising. Maybe this is like a shift in the flow for me, and maybe it's time to actually dedicate myself to a bit of practice.

[00:16:41.770] - Chris Johnstone

There's times between clarity and that we need to allow the kind of unclarity that happens when we're moving from one thing to another. If we just want to stick with clarity, the danger is that we never step outside the door because we can get to know our home incredibly well. But there's that lovely saying: "ships are safe in harbours, but that's not what ships are for" - it's by stepping outside what's familiar that we extend and grow and learn.

[00:17:18.770] - Madeleine Young

And I think this is where the spiral is so important, because in this moment between clarity, it's actually really valuable to go back and make some space for my feelings and honour them, because that's where the kind of fertile stuff for these new sprouts is going to come from. And in fact, when you were explaining before - at the beginning of this talk about going forth - I really got a sense of like, yeah, that's why going forth is different than just trying to think about these things just without doing anything else first, because the whole thing is going forth is the fourth stage of this four stage process.

[00:18:06.050] - Madeleine Young

And so it's like that the other stages have all brought us to this moment. So that having actually seen from our hopes, all of that has prepared the ground, which is what's different than just suddenly thinking, what am I going to do?

[00:18:23.270] - Chris Johnstone

Yes. And I think also in that, what am I going to do? It's fantastic to do visioning and identifying new things. And also sometimes we're doing too much. And so a really great question is, what am I not going to do or what am I already doing? That is actually just really excellent. And if I just keep on with that, that would be a really brilliant thing. And so - we talked about this a while ago - about seeing these three dimensions as a way just to reflect for ourselves and saying, hey, how am I showing up?

[00:19:01.310] - Chris Johnstone

How am I showing up in the Great Turning and how satisfied am I? And it might be actually, that in terms of my own response, I've got plenty going on just now, and it's good to reflect on what are the holding actions I'm involved in, the ways that I'm acting as a defender in all kinds of different ways? What are the ways that I'm involved in supporting the new shoots of sustainable practices and systems? And what are the ways I'm involved in consciousness shift? And if there are gaps, how does that feel?

[00:19:39.710] - Chris Johnstone

Sometimes it might be, well, I've done lots of that at another time. And actually, I'm feeling more called here at the moment, or it might be actually, I haven't been involved in that very much at all for a while. Or if ever and I'd be really interested to explore it more.

[00:20:00.770] - Madeleine Young

I think if that was the case for me, then I'd be thinking, what do I need? What would support me? And actually the storyboard process would come in handy then.

[00:20:13.190] - Chris Johnstone

So we're going to be doing that now, and we just invite you as you're watching this now - the storyboarding - to invite you to include maybe there's new things you're called to, but also maybe it's about acknowledging what you're already doing, and you might even want to do that before the storyboarding just to reflect saying, hey, how am I doing with my going forth? In what ways am I already going forth? And am I feeling called in new directions or also sometimes letting go of things is what's necessary in order to make room for something new.